for the mesh preview when keyframing. You can see the mesh in shade view in the Perspective viewport.

Now go to Frame 1 on the timeline and hit the Auto Key button to activate it. Go to frame 20 and use the Select and Uniform Scale tool to scale the circle. Similarly, go to each successive twentieth frame and keyframe the circle using various scaling values. The best way is to scale up and down during keyframing. Remember to scale the circle within the square.

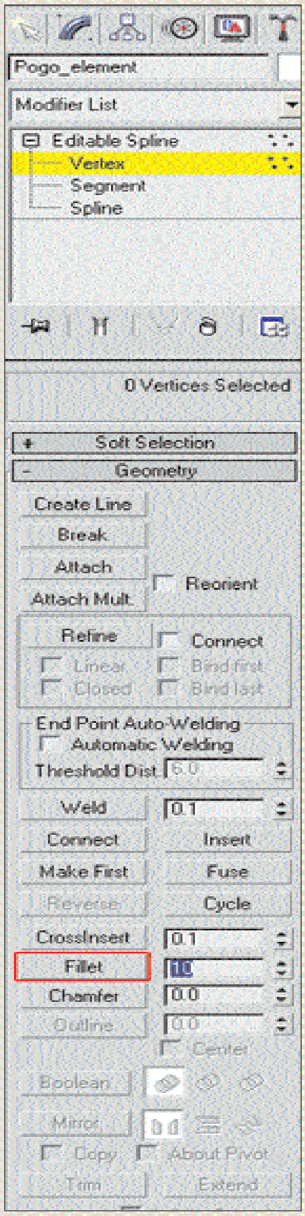
Now your basic shape is animated. Save this file as, say, Pogoanim_ master.max

The rounded corner

Use the Fillet option to create the rounded top-right edge. To get a better view, click on the 'Zoom Extents All' button. This fits the shape to the best size in all viewports.

The magic button to fit views in all the viewports

Here's how you fillet the edge: select the 'Pogo_element' and click the Modify tab in the Command panel. Here, the selected object is shown as an editable spline object. Click on the '+' to open up the sub-object controls. Click on the 'Vertex sub-object' and then on the top-right vertex of the 'Pogo_element' in the Front

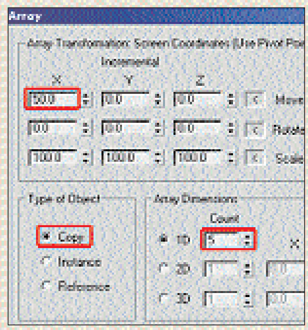


The Fillet dialog box helps you create those round edged corners

viewport. Now, enter '10' in the Fillet box and press ***[Enter]***. Your Pogo shape is now ready. Save this file as Pogo_master.max. For other techniques, remember to save it as a new file before starting a new project.

Creating an array of animated shapes

Use the array command to create duplicates of the basic shape. Remember to save as this file as tech2.max. Select the object, and go to the ***Tools > Array*** command from the top menu bar. We will now duplicate 10 copies on the X-axis. Note that the size of our master object is 50 units. In the Move incremental field, set a value of 50. Select type of object as

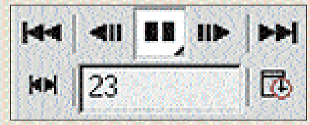


Make multiple duplicates in a jiffy

Copy. In the array dimensions, select 1D with a count of 5 and click OK. The shape is repeated across the X-axis with edge-to-edge accuracy. Move the slider on the timeline from 0 to 100 and you will find that even the animation parameters are copied with the object.

Randomising animation

Notice that all the circles are animated in a similar way on the timeline. We can now bring in some variation by selecting each object and shifting the keyframe.



The Play/Pause toggle controls playback

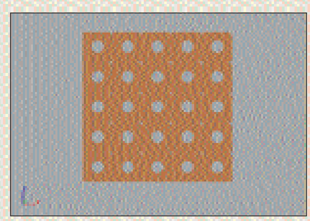
Select the second object in the series and move each keyframe marker that appears on the timeline to a different position. For example, move the keyframe marker 1 to frame 5, keyframe marker 20 to frame 35, and so on. This done, check the playback by selecting the perspective view and clicking the Play Animation button next to the timeline. Repeat this procedure for all the objects. On playback, the circles are animating at different time intervals.

Save this file as tech3.max.

Make an instanced array

Select all the 5 animated objects and go to the Tools - array command again. Click on 'Reset All Parameters'. Enter 50 as the value in the incremental Y Move field. Select instance as the type of object. Enter 5 as the array dimensions 1D and click OK.

Notice that this creates a new set of objects on the Y-axis. Go to the timeline and



The Perspective viewport shows the model with instanced arrays